

Read Scaffolds

Vocabulary Guide

Directions: Highlight the following vocabulary words in the text. Use the questions to make predictions about the part of speech and the definition of the word.

suspects

Look at paragraph 3. Ask yourself:

- Is the word a noun, a verb, an adjective, or an adverb?
- What crime is being described in the paragraph?
- What is the relationship between the six characters and the crime?

insensibility

Look at paragraph 4. Ask yourself:

- Is the word a noun, a verb, an adjective, or an adverb?
- What does the unidentified character do to the young man?
- Would a person most likely remain awake and aware after such a “brutal act”?

debunking

Look at paragraph 6. Ask yourself:

- Is the word a noun, a verb, an adjective, or an adverb?
- What kinds of films do people expect Hitchcock to make?
- What difference does Hitchcock point out between how people describe his movies and how he sees his own films?

plausible

Look at paragraphs 11 and 12. Ask yourself:

- Is the word a noun, a verb, an adjective, or an adverb?
- What kinds of people does Hitchcock include as characters in his films?
- What kinds of things does Hitchcock say are not necessary to create suspense?

Speaking Frames

Directions: Use the speaking frames as you discuss the text.

1. Letting the audience “play God” means _____.
 - Check paragraph 5.
 2. Hitchcock makes _____.
 - Check paragraph 6.
 3. A “whodunit” film is _____.
 - Check paragraph 9.
 4. *Rope* is not a whodunit film because _____.
 - Check paragraph 9.
 5. Suspense films need characters and situations that are _____.
 - Check paragraph 11.
 6. Hitchcock wants to create a contrast between _____ and _____.
 - Check paragraphs 13–15.
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Think Scaffolds

Text-Dependent Question Guide

Directions: Use the text-dependent question guide below as you complete the Think Questions.

Question 1

- What details does Hitchcock give about the plot?
- How does he want audiences to react?
- What kinds of movies make audiences react like that?

Question 2

- What happens at the beginning of *Rope*?
- Why isn't *Rope* a puzzler or whodunit film?
- How does Hitchcock build suspense?

Question 3

- What happens in the plot of *Rope*?
- What might the audience wonder about the killers?
- What might the audience wonder about the guests?

Question 4

- Read: "Suppose, for instance, you have six characters involved in a mystery. A man has been murdered and all six are possible **suspects** but no one is sure including the audience."
- What is the mystery described in the paragraph?
- What does that tell me about the meaning of the word *suspects*?

Question 5

- Read: “In order to achieve this, one of the necessary ingredients of the formula is a series of **plausible** situations with people that are real. When characters are unbelievable you never get suspense, only surprise.”
 - What kinds of people are described?
 - What kinds of characters does Hitchcock want to avoid?
 - What does that tell me about the meaning of the word *plausible*?
 - Write your definition of *plausible* here and identify clues that helped you figure out its meaning. Then check the meaning in a dictionary.
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